

Building Consulting Slides for Data Analysts



A framework for turning data analysis into impactful business presentations

1. Understand the Business & Audience

Goal:

Before building any slide, understand the business problem and tailor your message to the audience.

Key Actions:

Clarify the business requests

Example: "Why is Q1 revenue down?"

Identify Stakeholders

- **Executives:**
ROI, trends, big-picture insights
- **Middle managers:**
Operational metrics and decisions
- **Analysts/technical teams:**
Methodology and metrics

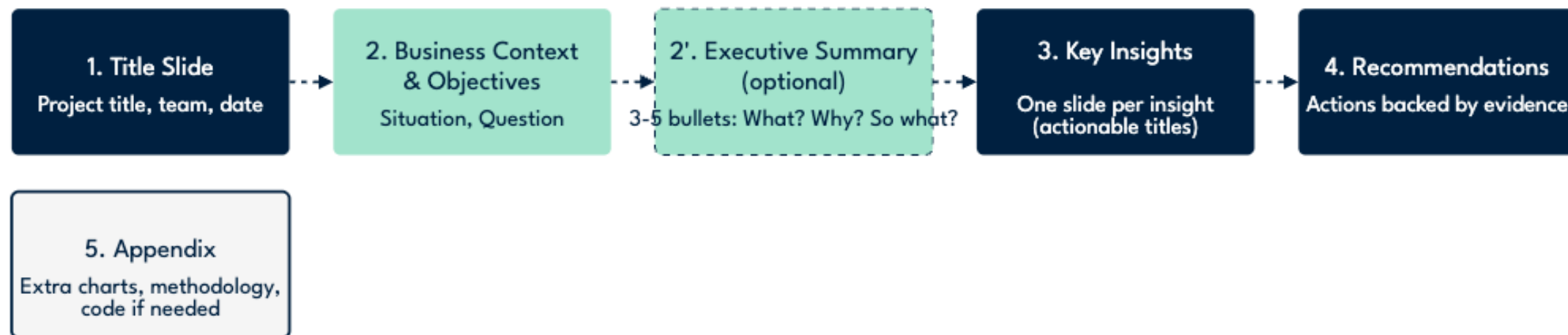
Scope the Analysis

Define what's in and out of scope:

- Time range
- Key Performance Indicators
- Customer segments involved
- Data sources and limitations

2. Structure Your Slide Deck Like a Consultant

Slide Deck Flow:

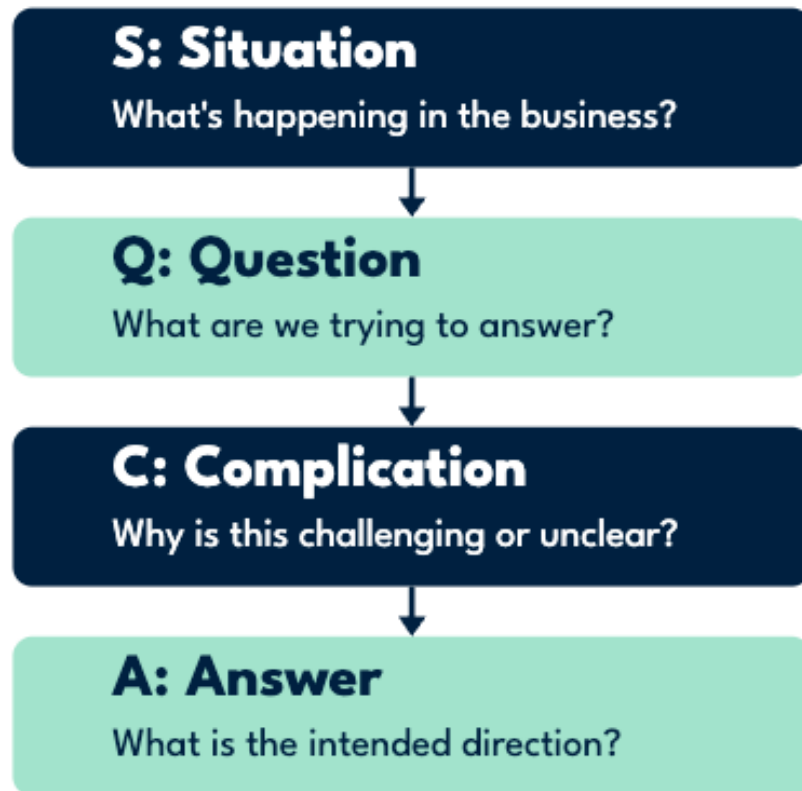


Pro Tips for Slide Structure:

- Start with your strongest insights first
- Each slide title should tell a complete story with data
- Maintain consistent formatting throughout the deck
- Keep slide formats consistent
- Use appendix for supporting details
- Make sure each slide can stand alone if needed

The SQCA Framework

A structured approach to frame business context and objectives



Example:

S: Situation

Our Q1 revenue is down 12% compared to last year.

Q: Question

Why has our revenue decreased and how can we reverse it?

C: Complication

Multiple factors could be at play: market conditions, product issues, competition, or internal processes.

A: Answer

We need to analyze our B2B customer retention and delivery performance to recover lost revenue.

Pro Tip: Use the SQCA framework in your introduction slide to provide a clear and structured business context before presenting your analysis and recommendations.

The SQCA Framework

SCQA Component	Purpose	Example (Customer Churn Analysis)
S (Situation)	Establish context & define the current state.	"Our customer base has been growing steadily over the past 3 years."
C (Complication)	Introduce the problem or challenge.	"However, our churn rate has increased by 20% in the last 6 months."
Q (Question)	Pose a key question that needs to be answered.	"What factors are driving customer churn?"
A (Answer)	Provide data-driven insights & recommendations.	"Our analysis shows that poor onboarding and late customer support responses are the main reasons."

3. Apply Storytelling with the Pyramid Principle

Concept:

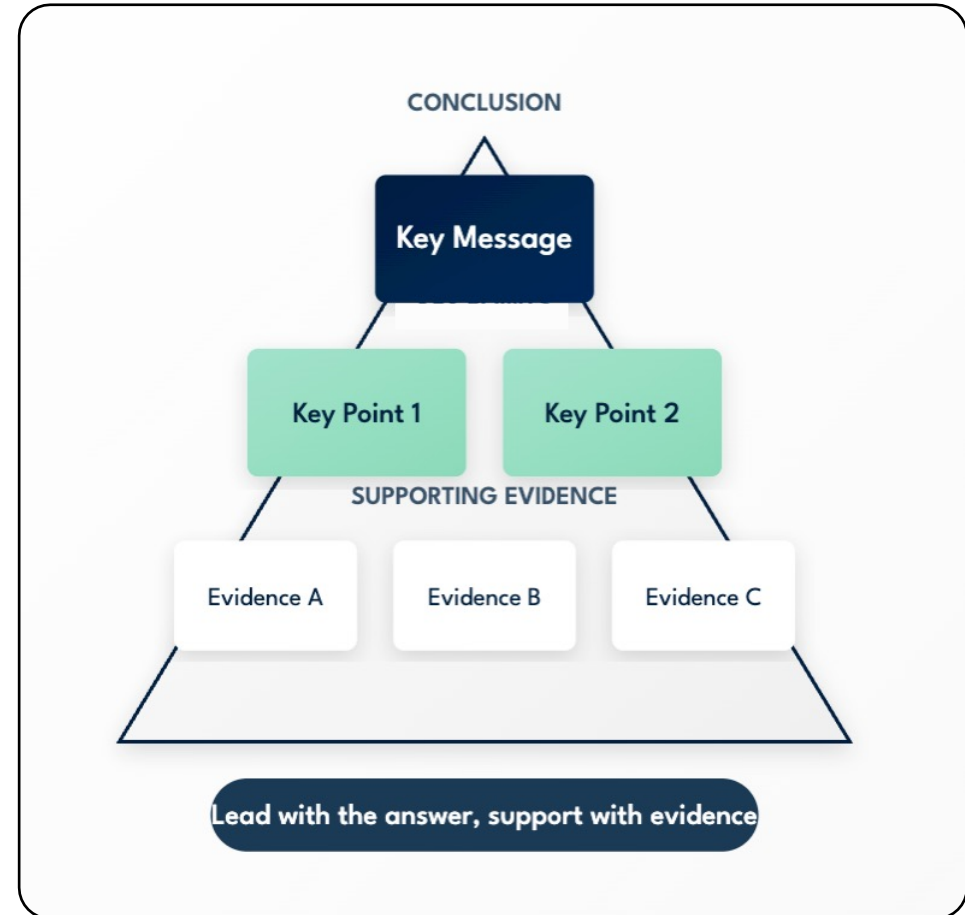
Lead with the answer, support with evidence.

Slide Format:

March Revenue Dropped 15% YoY Due to Product Recall

[Chart or Visualization]

The recall affected 3 key product lines, impacting 40% of our offering
Customer retention remained strong at 92% despite the recall



4. Visualize Data with Purpose

Choose the Right Chart Type:

For Comparisons



Bar/Column



Scatter Plot

For Distributions



Histogram



Box Plot

For Composition



Pie Chart



Stacked Area

For Trends



Line Chart



Area Chart

Best Practices:

- One chart per slide (unless comparison requires more)
- Label key data points
- Add annotations (arrows, comments)
- Use consistent color coding
- Choose chart complexity based on audience

Avoid:



3D pie charts or overly decorative visuals



Raw data tables in main slides (move to appendix)

5. Communicate Insights, Not Just Numbers

Insight-Driven Slide Titles:

BAD: "Sales Breakdown by Region"

Describes the chart type but doesn't offer any insight

Checklist for Insight Slides:

- ✓ Title = Actionable message with data
- ✓ Visual = Focused, clear, clean
- ✓ Commentary = Supports the story
- ✓ One clear takeaway per slide

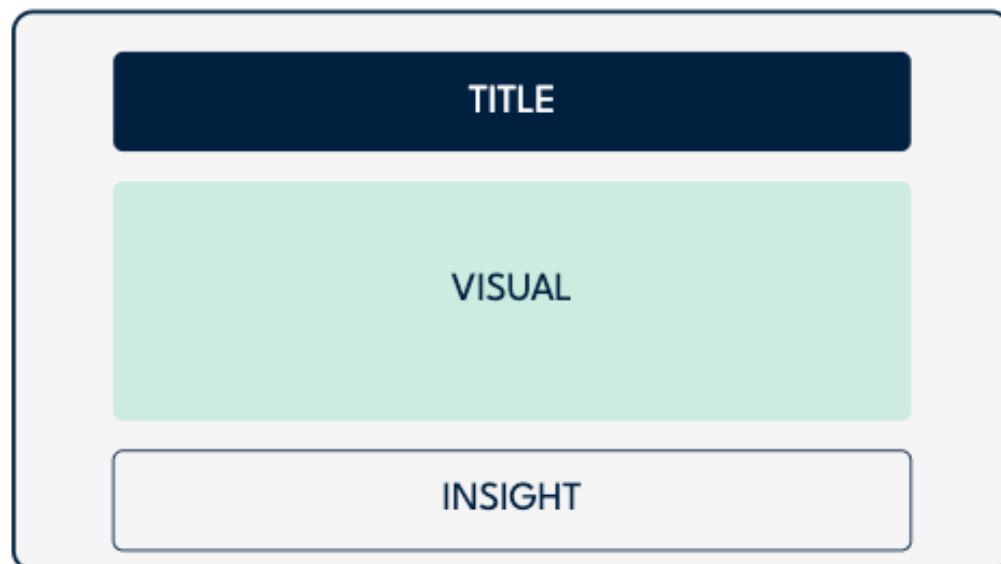
Use the Data Story Arc:



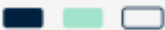
Pro Tip: Always lead with the "So what?" — why the audience should care about your findings.
Build slides that can stand alone, even if read without explanation.

6. Layout & Design Rules

Structure Your Slides with a Grid:



Design Principles:

- Use whitespace effectively to reduce clutter
- Keep font sizes readable (minimum 16pt)
- Stick to brand colors or a minimal palette

- Align elements consistently (left, right, center)
- Use contrast to highlight important points
- Be selective - include only what's necessary

Pro Tips:

- Always lead with the "So what?" — why your audience should care
- Build slides that can stand alone (even if read without voice-over)
- Rehearse: Can you explain each slide in under 1 minute?
- Consider your audience's expertise when designing visuals
- Balance text and visuals (avoid text-heavy slides)
- Keep layouts consistent throughout your presentation
- Number your slides for easy reference in discussion
- Test your slides with a colleague before presenting

Example

Marketing Campaign Performance Analysis



Fashion Store

Jul to Nov.2024

Example



Fashion Store ran 190 marketing campaigns from July to November, aiming to drive clicks, conversions, and customer engagement. These campaigns utilized various advertising formats and promotional strategies while leveraging seasonal trends to optimize campaign performance and maximize revenue.

Campaign Performance Evaluation:

- Seasonal trend analysis
- Performance metrics: Clicks, Impressions, Cost, P&L

Optimization Strategies for Ads Spending & Promotions:

- Optimizing advertising spend
- Enhancing promotional strategies

Example

Analysis Framework

- A. Comprehensive Overview of Advertising Performance**
- B. Evaluating the Impact of Promotional Strategies**
- C. Key Takeout & Recommendation**



Apply Pyramid Framework

Marketing Campaign Performance Analysis | [Overview](#)

Although the number of ads stayed the same, **clicks and impressions spiked in November** after being stagnant for months.



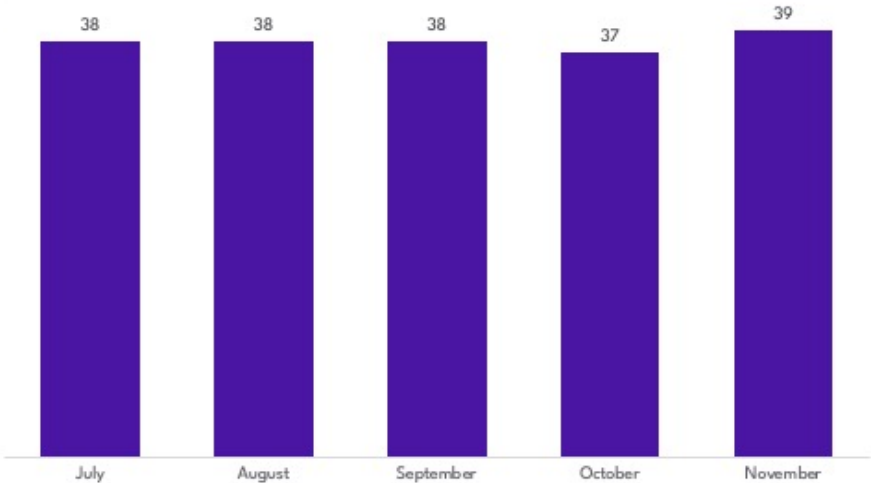
Ad volume remained **stable at around 38 ads per month**, with only a slight increase in November (39 ads).



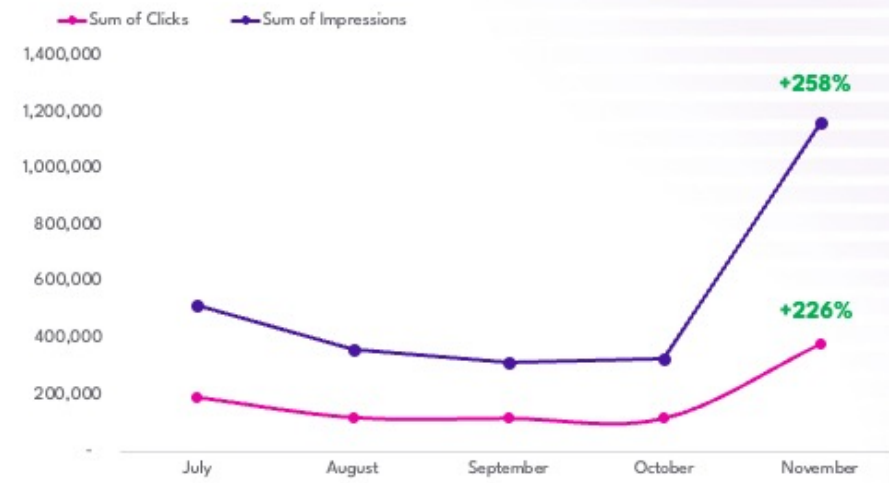
Clicks and impressions declined from July to October, indicating stagnation in engagement. However, November saw a dramatic surge in **impressions (+258%)** and **clicks (+226%)**, despite no major change in ad volume, suggesting increased budget allocation or improved campaign visibility.



Total Ads by Month



Engagement Trendline

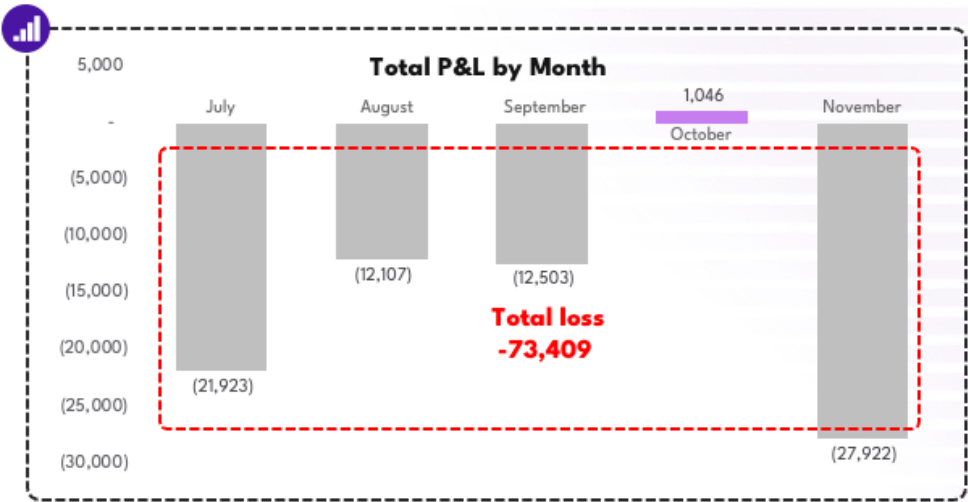
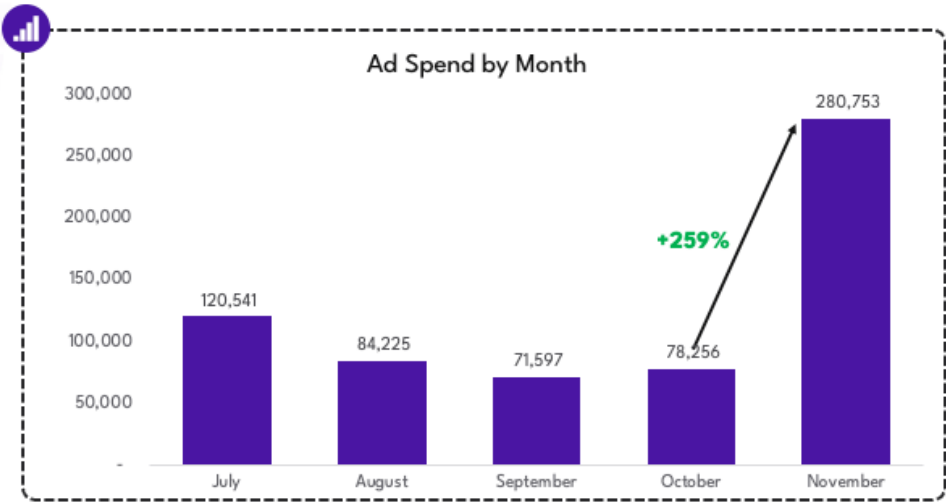


Apply Pyramid Framework

Marketing Campaign Performance Analysis | [Overview](#)

Increased ad spend did not translate to profitability, **highlighting inefficiencies in budget allocation.**

October's controlled spending (78K) led to profitability (+1K), while November's budget surge (280K) lacked efficiency, resulting in a significant loss (-27K). Stable spending from July to October (71K-120K) highlighted past inefficiencies, proving that higher investment alone (+259% in November) doesn't guarantee better outcomes.



Analyze and evaluate how **different promotional strategies** impact **ad spend efficiency, conversion rates, and profitability.**



THANK YOU!

SEE YOU AROUND, DATA-HOLICS!